

HOUSE RESOLUTION 143

By Johnson

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Dr. Ashleigh Elain McKinzie.

WHEREAS, the members of this legislative body along with the members of the Middle Tennessee State University community were greatly saddened to learn of the tragic passing of Dr. Ashleigh Elain McKinzie; and

WHEREAS, a tenured professor of Sociology and Women's and Gender Studies at Middle Tennessee State University, Dr. McKinzie was fatally shot on December 4, 2025; and

WHEREAS, born on April 27, 1984, in Arkansas, Dr. McKinzie graduated from the University of Georgia, earning her Doctor of Philosophy degree in Sociology before becoming a professor at Middle Tennessee State University in 2017; and

WHEREAS, a professor for nine years before her untimely death, Dr. Ashleigh McKinzie had an immeasurable passion for education, teaching topics such as sociological theory, social inequality, global feminism, and racial and gender inequalities; and

WHEREAS, Dr. McKinzie's passion for education extended far beyond the classroom, having served as a member of several graduate students' thesis committees; she collaborated with and empowered students to complete their master's degree theses and conduct their own research, with many of her students inspired to publish their research and continue their education through doctoral programs; and

WHEREAS, Dr. McKinzie was devoted to discovering and discussing inequalities throughout society; her research explored inequalities exacerbated by natural disasters, and she applied her knowledge and experience of social inequalities by teaching her students and advocating for the dismantling of power hierarchies and inequalities; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Ashleigh McKinzie will be remembered for her vivacious spirit and her ability to light up a room with her vibrant presence; and

WHEREAS, Dr. McKinzie is deeply loved and appreciated by her students and colleagues alike, and she leaves behind an inspiring legacy of education, mentorship, and advocacy and spreading love, joy, and positivity; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should pay tribute to her bountiful life of purpose and service; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that we honor and celebrate the life of Dr. Ashleigh Elain McKinzie, extending our sympathy and offering our condolences to her family, friends, colleagues, students, and the Middle Tennessee State University community.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy.